into Slavery. Lately an Armenian vessel coming from Astrachan was attacked; she had about 20 people on board who were armed. They defended themselves and beat off the Turkuman boats with the loss of 2 killed and three wounded.

The total number of Russian vessels of war is seventy-five Brigs each carrying 6 guns on 2 Cutters with 4 guns each. There are 40 Merchant Brigs 12 of these belong to Meer Ibrahim Khan — 8 to other Persians and the remainder to Russians and Armenians.

Mirza Alexander sounded all the rivers of Mazanderand and Ghilan till he came to the Sifeedrood when he proposed doing so there but Meer Ibrahim Khan firmly and successfully opposed it and wrote to Auglar Khan, then Govr. warning him of what had been going on, this note was enclosed to Count Simonitch and formed one of the subjects of complaint of the Russian Govt. to Meer Abou Talib.

[CHARLES BURGESS TO MESSRS. C. S. HANSON AND CO., *Constantinople*]

London, March, 1839

In order to reply to the queries put by your house here to me, I must refer to the events of the last seven months, which have had so unfortunate an influence over all my undertakings. Premising that I can only do so imperfectly being still confined to my room, and in too weak a state to write at much length.

You are aware that when the goods you now hold were sent to you, nothing was anticipated, but that the political relations between Eng^d^. and Persia would have gone on in their usual course. Most unhappily the result has been totally different. When the news of the first breech between the Schah and Mr. McNeill arrived a total stop was put to my proceedings. When we got intelligence of every thing being settled, I again set to work and got delivered in London, circa £6000 value of cotton manufactures. The last parcel of these had not reached London when the news of the last rupture with Persia came, and nearly at the same time I again fell ill, probably from exposure in the winter, and for now nearly two months I have been in bed or on the sofa. The goods all remain at the carriers warehouses, but I think you will perceive that as matters now stand it is impossible for me to come to any decision about them *immediately*. You know that all my transactions are so mixed up together that during a suspension of intercourse between the two countries it is out of the question for me to make any movement. Those best informed here expect all to be very shortly settled; sh'd this be the case the goods I now have would immediately come out to you, and I should proceed with my other transactions. This however is certain, that until I see my way more clearly than at present, I cannot make

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